

Maria NICULESCU-DUVAZ

CONTACT

ADDRESS: Flat 4, Bute House, 107 Brighton Road, SM2 5SL
PHONE: 07403823427
EMAIL: maria.niculescu-duvaz.13@ucl.ac.uk

WORK EXPERIENCE

<i>Sept 2017 -</i>	PhD student in Astrophysics at University College London (UCL) Studying for a PhD has required exceptional organization and intuition, as well as consolidated my teamwork and communication skills, as my research work is part of an international collaboration. I currently have two academic papers in the preparatory stages, have presented my work at several conferences and am comfortable using a variety of programming languages.
<i>October 2017 - March 2020</i>	ORBYTS Tutor I have created a research project for year 12 students based on my own work, which has involved creating an app, teaching students how to schedule telescope observations and how to use various software. As well as this, I have been part of management by recruiting PhD students for the scheme and lending support to other ORBYTS tutors. I have massively improved my science communication, teaching and organisational skills through the ORBYTS scheme.
<i>July 2018</i>	Summer school tutor at UCL As part of the UCL summer school run by the Physics and Astronomy department I led a day session where I taught students basic python and helped them write their own python codes to analyse and plot transit light curves of exoplanets.
<i>Sept 2016 - Jan 2017</i>	Transition Mentor for first year physics undergraduates I developed my communication and listening skills in this role, as I had to communicate scientific ideas concisely and clearly, as well as listen and give advice to students about a wide variety of issues facing them in University life.

VOLUNTEERING

<i>May 2019 -</i>	Outreach Representative for PhD students I am currently the Outreach representative for PhD students for the Outreach Committee in the Astrophysics department at UCL, where my aim is to develop strategies to increase outreach uptake in the department and deliver the ideas of my peers to the committee.
<i>Feb 2019</i>	Workshop Leader I created a problem-solving based workshop about the physics of cosmic dust and supernovae explosions, which I led for UCL SciCon for STEM undergraduates.
<i>May 2018-October 2019</i>	Demonstrator at Science Festivals I have demonstrated how waves propagate using props I helped create at the Nature Day of Light Festival, and I demonstrated a 3D supernova virtual reality app I co-created using data from my research at Your Universe Festival at UCL and the Bloomsbury science festival to a wide variety of audiences including schoolchildren.
<i>April 2018 - Jan 2019</i>	Outreach talks I have created and delivered two engaging entry-level science talks at Barking Abbey School and North London Collegiate school to pupils ranging from ages 13-18 about the life cycle of stars.

EDUCATION

2013-2017	MSci ASTROPHYSICS, University College London, UK 1 st Class MSci
2007-2012	Nonsuch High School for Girls, Cheam, UK <i>A-levels:</i> Mathematics A*, Physics A, Chemistry A <i>GCSEs:</i> 5 A*s, 5 As, 1 B

INTERESTS

Astronomy, Drawing and Painting, Rock Climbing, Mountaineering, Rollerblading, Literature, Birdwatching